DSA REFERENCE

1D Dynamic Programming Problem Ladder

A sequenced practice ladder from warm-up to interview stretch.

Cache the answer for each smaller one-dimensional state so overlapping subproblems are solved once.

VERSION 1.0 REVIEW
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STATUS HUMAN REVIEW REQUIRED

DSA / DYNAMIC-PROGRAMMING-1D

DSA

1D Dynamic Programming Problem Ladder

CORE IDEA

Cache the answer for each smaller one-dimensional state so overlapping subproblems are solved once.

Recognition cues

+ count or optimize across a sequence
+ take/skip choices
+ prefix-dependent answer
+ repeated recursion state

Implementation sequence

+ write state in words
+ derive transition from the last decision
+ set base cases
+ choose iteration order
+ compress only after correctness

Invariant

dp[i] has one precise meaning and is final before any later state reads it.

Worked reasoning

House Robber uses dp[i] = max(dp[i-1], dp[i-2] + value[i]); the last decision is skip or take.

Complexity

Usually O(n) time and O(n) space, often compressible to O(1) when only recent states are read.

Failure modes

- [ ] vague state meaning
- [ ] wrong base cases
- [ ] invalid iteration order
- [ ] greedy reasoning where future effects matter

Practice ladder

1D Dynamic Programming Problem Ladder: referenced problems

Open the official problem page, classify the pattern, write the invariant, and predict the complexity before coding.

#	Problem	Deliberate-practice prompt
1	Climbing Stairs	State the cue, invariant, edge case, and proof before implementation.
2	House Robber	State the cue, invariant, edge case, and proof before implementation.
3	Coin Change	State the cue, invariant, edge case, and proof before implementation.
4	Word Break	State the cue, invariant, edge case, and proof before implementation.
5	Longest Increasing Subsequence	State the cue, invariant, edge case, and proof before implementation.

Before coding

+ Pattern cue
+ State
+ Invariant
+ Boundary convention

Before finishing

+ Dry run
+ Edge case
+ Time proof
+ Space proof

PUBLISHING STATUS

REVIEW GATE: STABLE TECHNICAL. AI-produced draft. A named human must verify technical accuracy, sourcing, freshness, and editorial quality before publication. Reviewed-through date: 2026-07-18.